

Typography, iconography & motion — type ramp, icon system, motion tokens

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Master technical specification — Volume 10 (Design System), nano-detail deep-dive. This document **owns** three of HelixVPN's design-token families that sit alongside the colour system: the **typographic ramp** (display / headline / title / body / label tiers, each a triple of size / line-height / weight, all as tokens), the **font-family strategy** per platform (system vs bundled, the §11.4.162 no-overlap / no-collision concern, font licensing flagged as a decision), the **iconography system** (icon-set strategy, the sizing grid, the per-platform asset forms SVG / icon-font / native), and the **motion / animation token system** (durations, easing curves, the named transitions that drive the connection-state UI, and the reduced-motion accessibility contract).

SPEC-ONLY. It defines *what the type/icon/motion tokens are and how they resolve into each platform's form* — not the shipping `helix_design` build. The token **structure** these live in (tiers, schema, the `$value/$type` envelope, the `font.* / motion.*` categories) is owned by `[design-tokens.md]`; the **colours** the type and icons are painted in by `[color-system.md]`; the **multi-form emit** (how a `font.semantic.body.md` becomes a SwiftUI Font, a Compose TextStyle, ...) by `[token-export-pipeline.md]`. This document is **original HelixVPN design work** — the ramp, the icon grid, the motion curves are owned here.

Boundary with sibling docs. Owns: the type-scale values, the font-family matrix, the icon grid + asset-form policy, the motion durations/curves/named transitions, the reduced-motion contract. Consumes: the token tier/naming model

- the font/motion `$type` envelopes `[design-tokens.md §2, §3, §6.4]`; the connection-state palette + the 7-variant `ffi::TunnelStatus` the motion transitions are keyed to `[color-system.md §3]`, `[v04-client/ffi-surface.md §3.2]`; the 3-app / 8-platform matrix `[SPECIFICATION.md §3]`; the OpenDesign `DESIGN.md §3` (Typography) / §6 (Motion) authoring form `[opendesign-foundation.md §3.2]`.

Evidence base. [DT §N] = final/v10-design/design-tokens.md; [COLOR §N] = final/v10-design/color-system.md; [OD §N] = final/v10-design/opendesign-foundation.md; [OV §N] = final/v10-design/00-overview-and-submodule.md; [FFI §N] = final/v04-client/ffi-surface.md; [SPINE §N] = final/SPECIFICATION.md. Claims not grounded in the evidence base or in this document's own original design choices are tagged UNVERIFIED per constitution §11.4.6 — never fabricated. Font *licensing* facts (Inter, JetBrains Mono) are tagged UNVERIFIED pending the verification pass mandated by §11.4.99 (latest-source cross-reference before any guide is published).

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0. Position & the three families

The colour system [color-system.md] answers *what colour means what*. This document answers the other three questions a design system must answer for every one of HelixVPN's **3 apps** × **8 platforms**:

Family	Category root [DT §2]	Owns	The product-defining slice
Typography	font.*	the type ramp (size/line-height/weight tiers), font families, the per-platform font emit	the StatusChip / ConnectButton label legibility; mono for keys/IPs
Iconography	icon.* (+ size.* for the grid)	the icon set, the sizing grid, the asset forms (SVG / font / native)	the per-state icon (shield-check, spinner, warning-triangle) that carries state without colour (CVD ally, [COLOR §0])
Motion	motion.*	durations, easing curves, named	the Connecting/Reconnecting pulse, the

Family	Category root [DT §2]	Owens	The product-defining slice
		transitions, reduced-motion	state cross-fade, the connect ring

All three obey the same three-tier token model [DT §1] (primitive → semantic → component) and the same one-source / zero-drift rule [DT §0]: one JSON source, every consumable form generated [token-export-pipeline.md]. All three also obey §11.4.162: light + dark where colour is involved (icons are colour-tinted, so they ship a light + dark tint), no element overlap, no label overlay, and visual-regression coverage on every change.

flowchart LR

```

    subgraph SRC["helix_design tokens/** (one source)"]
        T["font.* (type)"]; I["icon.* + size.* (icons)"];
        M["motion.* (motion)"]
    end
    subgraph CONSUME["every consuming surface"]
        C["ConnectButton / StatusChip / ServerList / dialogs"]
    end
    T --> C; I --> C; M --> C
    M -. "keyed to ffi::TunnelStatus (§7)" .-> C
    I -. "per-state glyph carries state w/o colour (a11y)" .-> C
    classDef s fill:#eef,stroke:#3D5AF1;

```

1. The typographic ramp

The ramp is **five tiers** — display, headline, title, body, label — each with a small closed set of sizes. Every step is a **triple**: a font **size** (dimension), a **line-height** (number, unitless multiplier), and a **weight** (fontWeight). The ramp is a **modular scale** anchored at body.md = 14px with a ratio of **1.25** (major third) rounded to the 4-pt grid [DT §6.1] so every size lands on a clean device pixel.

1.1 The full ramp (all tiers, all steps)

Token	Size	Line-height (×)	Computed LH	Weight	Family	Typical use
font.semantic.display.lg	40px	1.10	44px	bold 700	sans	onboarding hero, splash
font.semantic.display.md	32px	1.15	37px	bold 700	sans	empty-state title
font.semantic.headline.lg	28px	1.20	34px	semibold 600	sans	screen title (Console master)
font.semantic.headline.md	24px	1.25	30px	semibold 600	sans	dialog title, section header
font.semantic.title.lg	20px	1.30	26px		sans	

Token	Size	Line-height (×)	Computed LH	Weight	Family	Typical use
				semibold 600		card title, ConnectButton label
font.semantic.title.md	18px	1.35	24px	medium 500	sans	list-section title
font.semantic.title.sm	16px	1.40	22px	medium 500	sans	ExitPicker row primary
font.semantic.body.lg	16px	1.50	24px	regular 400	sans	reading copy (settings help)
font.semantic.body.md	14px	1.50	21px	regular 400	sans	default body — most text
font.semantic.body.sm	13px	1.45	19px	regular 400	sans	secondary/ supporting text
font.semantic.label.lg	14px	1.20	17px	medium 500	sans	button label, tab
font.semantic.label.md	12px	1.30	16px	medium 500	sans	StatusChip text, badge
font.semantic.label.sm	11px	1.30	14px	semibold 600	sans	underline, uppercase eyebrow
font.semantic.mono.md	13px	1.45	19px	regular 400	mono	IP / pubkey / fingerprint / region code
font.semantic.mono.sm	12px	1.40	17px	regular 400	mono	inline key fragments, log

Why anchor at body.md = 14px, not 16px. HelixVPN's densest surfaces are the Console server table and the Client ExitPicker/log — list-heavy, many rows visible at once. A 14px body keeps row density high while body.lg = 16px serves prose (settings help). Reading copy that the user *reads* (not scans) uses body.lg; chrome/labels use label.*. This is the original HelixVPN choice; both clear the platform minimum-legible floors (iOS Dynamic Type body 17pt is met by body.lg for accessibility-large; the 14px default is a dense-UI baseline, never the only size for body prose).

1.2 The modular scale (visualised)

flowchart TD

```

    subgraph SCALE["Modular type scale – anchor body.md=14, ratio 1.25, snapped to 4-pt grid"]
        d1["display.lg · 40 / 700"]
        d2["display.md · 32 / 700"]
        h1["headline.lg · 28 / 600"]
        h2["headline.md · 24 / 600"]
        t1["title.lg · 20 / 600 ← ConnectButton label"]
        t2["title.md · 18 / 500"]
    end
  
```

```

t3["title.sm · 16 / 500"]
b1["body.lg · 16 / 400 ← reading copy"]
b2["body.md · 14 / 400 ★ ANCHOR (default body)"]
b3["body.sm · 13 / 400"]
l1["label.lg · 14 / 500"]
l2["label.md · 12 / 500 ← StatusChip"]
l3["label.sm · 11 / 600 (uppercase eyebrow)"]
m1["mono.md · 13 / 400 ← IP / pubkey"]
end
d1 --> d2 --> h1 --> h2 --> t1 --> t2 --> t3 --> b1 --> b2 -->
b3 --> l1 --> l2 --> l3
b2 -. "mono pair shares body sizes, different family" .-> m1

```

1.3 The tier semantics (when to use which)

Tier	Role	Never used for
display.*	one-per-screen marketing/hero moment (onboarding, splash, empty-state)	running UI; it is too large to repeat
headline.*	the screen's or dialog's single title	body or labels
title.*	section / card / row titles; the ConnectButton label (title.lg, large-bold → governs AA-large [COLOR §3.3])	long prose
body.*	sentences the user reads or scans; settings descriptions	a button label (use label.*)
label.*	chrome: buttons, tabs, chips, badges, the StatusChip (label.md)	a paragraph
mono.*	anything the user might copy/compare character-by-character — IP, WireGuard pubkey, fingerprint, region code, log line	prose (proportional reads faster)

mono.* is product-load-bearing. A VPN UI shows keys, IPs, fingerprints and exit identifiers the user verifies character-by-character (is this *really* my pubkey?). A proportional font makes 1/1/I and 0/0 ambiguous — a real security-legibility hazard, not a stylistic preference. Every such value uses mono.* (a slashed-zero / disambiguated mono — see §2.3).

2. Font families per platform (system vs bundled)

2.1 The strategy — bundled sans/mono for brand consistency, with a system fallback chain

HelixVPN's primary surface is **one Flutter codebase** [SPINE §3], where bundling the font guarantees the **same** glyphs render on all 8 platforms (a system-font strategy would make iOS render SF Pro, Android Roboto, Windows Segoe — the "connected" label would have a different shape per OS, a brand-consistency leak). The chosen bundled families (primitive tokens [DT §4]):

Primitive token	Family	Role
font.primitive.family.sans	Inter	all proportional text (display→label)
font.primitive.family.mono	JetBrains Mono	all monospace (keys/IPs/logs)

These bind the semantic ramp's family column (§1.1). The **fallback chain** (if the bundled font fails to load, or on a native shim that cannot bundle) degrades to the platform system font, *never* to a random serif:

sans: Inter → -apple-system / SF Pro (Apple) → Roboto (Android/Harmony) →
 Segoe UI (Windows) → system-ui (Linux/Web/Aurora) → sans-serif
 mono: JetBrains Mono → ui-monospace / SF Mono (Apple) → Roboto Mono (Android) →
 Cascadia Code / Consolas (Windows) → monospace

2.2 The per-platform decision matrix

Platform	Flutter app surface	Native-shim surface (small)	Font delivery
iOS / macOS	bundle Inter + JetBrains Mono in the Flutter asset bundle	NE-config-UI / widgets (SwiftUI) — system font (SF Pro / SF Mono), brand sans not bundled into the tiny extension	Flutter bundles; native shims use system per §2.4
Android / HarmonyOS	bundle in Flutter	quick-settings tile / VPN-ability (Compose / ArkTS) — system font (Roboto / HarmonyOS Sans)	as above
Windows / Linux	bundle in Flutter	—	Flutter bundles
Web (Console)	bundle as a @font-face web font (woff2), with the fallback chain in the CSS export	—	self-host woff2 (no third-party CDN — privacy, [COLOR §0])
Aurora	bundle in Flutter; Qt/C++ shim (C-Qt export) uses the system font	Qt surface — system font	as above

D-TYPE-1 (surfaced, §10). *Native shims use the system font, not the brand font.* The iOS NE-extension / Android tile / HarmonyOS ability / Aurora Qt surfaces are tiny config UIs; bundling a 300 KB+ font family into each is disproportionate, and these surfaces show little text (a toggle + a status line). They render the **same palette** (the colour token export reaches them, [OV

§6]) but the **system font** — a deliberate, documented exception to brand sans, justified by binary-size + the surfaces' minimal text. The Flutter app — where the user spends ~all their time — is always brand-font.

2.3 Mono disambiguation requirement

The chosen mono (`font.primitive.family.mono`) MUST disambiguate the security-critical glyph pairs 0/0, 1/l/I, 5/S, 8/B. JetBrains Mono ships a slashed/dotted zero and distinct 1/l/I by design — the reason it is chosen over a generic mono. The §9 gate CM-type-mono-disambiguated is a *manual* design-review checkpoint (an automated glyph-shape oracle is UNVERIFIED — flagged §11.4.6, not claimed).

2.4 Licensing — flagged as a decision (§11.4.99)

D-TYPE-2 (open, §10) — font licensing. Inter (SIL Open Font License 1.1) and JetBrains Mono (Apache-2.0 / OFL depending on distribution) are both understood to permit embedding + web self-hosting, **but** the exact license text, version, and bundling terms MUST be verified against the **latest** upstream source per §11.4.99 (latest-source doc cross-reference) **before** any font file is committed to `helix_design/assets/fonts/` or a setup guide is published. The license file + the verified URL + access date go into `assets/fonts/<family>/LICENSE` and the §11.4.99 "Sources verified" footer. Marked **UNVERIFIED** here: the OFL/Apache assumption is *not* asserted as fact — it is the hypothesis the verification pass confirms. If a license turns out to forbid embedding, the fallback is a system-font-only strategy (§2.1 fallback chain becomes primary) — a §11.4.66 operator decision, not a silent swap. Composes [OV §13 D-DESIGN-5] (bundle-vs-reference font decision).

3. Type tokens — the JSON shape & per-platform emit

3.1 The composite type token

A type-ramp step is a **composite** — a small object of `size / lineHeight / weight / family` references, each a leaf of its own `$type` [DT §3.1]. The ramp lives in the semantic tier; components reference a whole step.

```
// helix_design/tokens/semantic/type.json (excerpt) – composite type tokens
{
  "font": { "semantic": {
    "body": {
      "md": {
        "$description": "default body text",
        "size": { "$type": "dimension", "$value": "14px" },
        "lineHeight": { "$type": "number", "$value": 1.50 },
        "weight": { "$type": "fontWeight", "$value":
```

```

    "{font.primitive.weight.regular}" },
      "family": { "$type": "fontFamily", "$value":
    "{font.primitive.family.sans}" }
  }
},
  "title": {
    "lg": {
      "$description": "card title / ConnectButton label",
      "size": { "$type": "dimension", "$value": "20px" },
      "lineHeight": { "$type": "number", "$value": 1.30 },
      "weight": { "$type": "fontWeight", "$value":
    "{font.primitive.weight.semibold}" },
      "family": { "$type": "fontFamily", "$value":
    "{font.primitive.family.sans}" }
    }
  },
  "mono": {
    "md": {
      "$description": "IP / pubkey / fingerprint",
      "size": { "$type": "dimension", "$value": "13px" },
      "lineHeight": { "$type": "number", "$value": 1.45 },
      "weight": { "$type": "fontWeight", "$value":
    "{font.primitive.weight.regular}" },
      "family": { "$type": "fontFamily", "$value":
    "{font.primitive.family.mono}" }
    }
  }
} }
}

```

// helix_design/tokens/component/connect_button.json (excerpt) – references the step

```

{
  "comp": { "connectButton": {
    "label": {
      "type": { "$type": "typeRef", "$value":
    "{font.semantic.title.lg}" },
      "color": { "$type": "color", "$value":
    "{color.semantic.text.onState}" }
    }
  } }
}

```

A component references a **whole** ramp step ({font.semantic.title.lg}) — it never re-specifies size/weight inline (a tier violation [DT §7]). The exporter expands the composite into each platform's native text-style object (§3.2).

3.2 Per-platform type emit (sample, all 6 forms)

The export pipeline [token-export-pipeline.md] expands one composite step into each target's idiomatic text style. The light/dark **colour** is applied by the component, not the type token (the type token is theme-invariant — size/weight/family do not fork by theme; only the colour the text is painted in does [DT §5.1]).

```
/* CSS – dist/css/helix.css */
.hx-font-title-lg {
  font-family: var(--hx-font-family-sans);
  font-size: 20px; line-height: 1.30; font-weight: 600;
}

// Dart – dist/dart/helix_tokens.dart (TextStyle, colour applied
// by widget)
static const TextStyle titleLg = TextStyle(
  fontFamily: 'Inter', fontSize: 20, height: 1.30, fontWeight:
  FontWeight.w600);

// SwiftUI – dist/swift/HelixTokens.swift
static let titleLg = Font.custom("Inter", size:
  20).weight(.semibold)
// line-height applied via .lineSpacing(20 * (1.30 - 1.0)) at the
// call site

// Jetpack Compose – dist/compose/HelixTokens.kt
val TitleLg = TextStyle(
  fontFamily = InterFamily, fontSize = 20.sp, lineHeight = 26.sp,
  fontWeight = FontWeight.W600)

// ArkTS – dist/arkts/helix_tokens.ets
export const titleLg = { fontFamily: 'Inter', fontSize: 20,
  lineHeight: 26, fontWeight: 600 };

// C/Qt – dist/cqt/helix_tokens.h
#define HX_FONT_TITLE_LG_FAMILY "Inter"
#define HX_FONT_TITLE_LG_SIZE_PX 20
#define HX_FONT_TITLE_LG_WEIGHT 600
#define HX_FONT_TITLE_LG_LH_PX 26
```

UNVERIFIED (U-TIM-1). The exact line-height idiom per platform (CSS unitless multiplier vs. Compose lineHeight in sp vs. SwiftUI's `.lineSpacing` additional spacing) is pinned by the export-pipeline contract test [token-export-pipeline.md §drift-gate]. The samples above state the *intended* mapping (multiplier → absolute sp/px where the platform needs absolute); marked UNVERIFIED until that contract test exists (§11.4.6).

4. The no-overlap / no-collision typographic rule (§11.4.162)

§11.4.162 mandates "fonts MUST NOT collide, labels MUST NOT overlay labels". At the **type layer** this is concrete (layout enforcement is [component-library.md] + visual regression [visual-regression-and-qa.md]; this is the type half):

1. **Line-height ≥ 1.30 for any multi-line text block** so descenders of one line never touch ascenders of the next (collision). The ramp encodes this: every `body.*`/`title.*` step is ≥ 1.30 (`title.lg` 1.30, `body.*` 1.45–1.50); only single-line `label.*` (chips, never wrapping) and `display.*` (one line, generous) drop below.
2. **A label never overlaps another label.** Two text runs in one component (e.g. the `ExitPicker` row's primary `title.sm` + secondary `body.sm`) are separated by $\geq \text{space.scale.1}$ (4px) vertical gap [DT §6.1], and the `StatusChip` label has $\geq \text{space.scale.2}$ (8px) horizontal padding so the text never touches the chip edge or an adjacent chip.
3. **Truncation, never overflow.** Any text that may exceed its container (a long exit name, a wide pubkey) truncates with an ellipsis (proportional) or a middle-ellipsis (mono keys — preserve both ends) — it never overflows to overlay a neighbour. The full value is available on hover/long-press.
4. **One type family per role, no mixed-family runs.** A single text run is one family (sans **or** mono) — a key is rendered entirely `mono.*`, its label entirely sans — never a mid-string family switch that produces a baseline collision.

These four rules are asserted by the visual-regression suite (golden screenshots per theme, OCR-readback to confirm no clipped/overlapping glyphs, §11.4.162 / §11.4.168) in [visual-regression-and-qa.md]; this document supplies the type contract they assert against.

5. Iconography — set strategy, grid, asset forms

5.1 Set strategy — one cohesive line-icon set, brand-tinted

HelixVPN uses **one** cohesive **stroke (line) icon set** at a uniform 1.5px optical stroke, drawn on a 24×24 grid (§5.2). One set (not a mix of filled + line + brand logos from different families) is what keeps the UI cohesive — a §11.4.162 design-system requirement.

D-ICON-1 (surfaced, §10) — base icon set. The recommended base is a permissively-licensed open line-icon set (e.g. **Lucide**, ISC license) extended with HelixVPN-bespoke glyphs for the VPN-specific concepts no generic set has (shield-check, shield-slash, tunnel, relay-hop, kill-switch, exit-node, split-tunnel). Per §11.4.74 the base set is reused, not reinvented, and bespoke glyphs are added in the HelixVPN style. The **exact** base set + its license are **UNVERIFIED** pending the §11.4.99 verification pass (same discipline as fonts, §2.4) — Lucide/ISC is the *hypothesis*, confirmed before any SVG is committed. Composes [OV §13 D-DESIGN-5].

5.2 The sizing grid

Icons are authored on a **24×24** base grid with a **2px live-area padding** (a 20×20 optical safe area), so a glyph never touches the bounding box (the icon analogue of the §4.2 label-padding rule). Rendered sizes are a closed token set keyed to `size.*`:

Token	Size	Stroke	Use
<code>icon.size.xs</code>	12px	1.25px	inline-with-label.sm, dense badges
<code>icon.size.sm</code>	16px	1.5px	inline-with-body/label, list-row leading
<code>icon.size.md</code>	20px	1.5px	default — buttons, nav, StatusChip glyph
<code>icon.size.lg</code>	24px	1.5px	section headers, dialog icons
<code>icon.size.xl</code>	32px	2px	empty-state, the ConnectButton centre glyph
<code>icon.size.2xl</code>	48px	2.5px	onboarding / hero

Stroke scales with size so optical weight stays constant (a 12px icon at 1.5px looks heavier than a 32px icon at 1.5px — hence the per-size stroke).

5.3 The per-state status icon set (carries state **WITHOUT** colour — CVD a11y)

The single most product-specific icon group: each of the 7 `ffi::TunnelStatus` variants [FFI §3.2] has a **distinct glyph** so a colour-blind user reads the state from the *shape*, not only the [COLOR §3] colour (the [COLOR §0] honest boundary — colour is reinforcement, never the sole channel).

<code>ffi::TunnelStatus</code>	<code>icon.semantic.state.*</code>	Glyph	Why distinct shape
Disconnected	<code>state.disconnected</code>	shield (outline, hollow)	"off" — empty shield
Connecting	<code>state.connecting</code>	spinner / 3-dot (animated, §7)	"working"
Handshaking	<code>state.handshaking</code>	spinner + key (animated)	"working — authenticating"
Connected{direct}	<code>state.connected</code>	shield-check (filled)	"protected, P2P" — the success glyph
Connected{relay}	<code>state.connectedRelay</code>	shield-check + relay-hop dots	"protected, relayed"
Reconnecting	<code>state.reconnecting</code>	circular-arrows	"retrying"

<code>ffi::TunnelStatus</code>	<code>icon.semantic.state.*</code>	Glyph	Why distinct shape
		(pulsing, §7)	
Down	<code>state.down</code>	shield-slash / broken-link	"dropped" — distinct from danger
Danger	<code>state.danger</code>	warning-triangle (!)	"exposed" — the universal alarm shape

The glyph + the [COLOR §3] colour + the text label are **three** redundant channels for the state — any one alone is sufficient to read it. Down (shield-slash) vs Danger (warning-triangle) are deliberately *different shapes*, not just different colours, so the two alarms are distinguishable under colour-vision deficiency (the [COLOR §3.2] rationale, satisfied at the icon layer).

5.4 Asset forms per platform

The icon source is **SVG** (the authoring form); the export pipeline [`token-export-pipeline.md`] emits the form each platform consumes:

Platform	Consumed icon form	How
Flutter (all app surfaces)	SVG via <code>flutter_svg</code> , or a generated icon font (<code>.ttf</code> + a Dart <code>IconData</code> map)	one source SVG → both; icon-font is smaller for the full set
Web (Console)	inline <code><svg></code> sprite (<code><symbol></code> + <code><use></code>) or an icon-font <code>@font-face</code>	sprite preferred (per-icon CSS colour)
iOS / macOS shim	SF Symbols where an equivalent exists; bespoke glyphs as SVG→PDF vector assets	system-consistent; bespoke as asset catalogue
Android / HarmonyOS shim	vector drawable (<code><vector></code>) / ArkTS resource	one source SVG → per-platform vector
Aurora (Qt)	SVG via Qt's SVG renderer	direct

Icons are **tinted at render** by a colour token (never baked-in colour in the SVG — the SVG uses `currentColor` / a single fill placeholder) so the same glyph serves light + dark (DS-I3) by swapping the tint token ([COLOR §3]); a state-icon's tint is its `color.semantic.state.*` value.

D-ICON-2 (surfaced, §10). SVG-direct vs. generated icon-font for Flutter (size vs. per-icon tint flexibility). Lean: **icon-font** for the static UI set (smaller, one glyph map) + **SVG-direct** for the few icons that need multi-colour or animation (the animated spinner/pulse, §7). Resolved at the Volume-10 assets review [OV §13]. UNVERIFIED until ratified.

6. Motion & animation token system

6.1 The motion token families

Motion lives in `motion.*` [DT §6.4]. Three leaf families compose into named transitions:

Family	\$type	Tokens
duration	duration	<code>motion.primitive.dur.{instant 0, fast 100, base 180, moderate 240, slow 360, pulse 1200}</code> (ms)
easing	cubicBezier	<code>motion.primitive.ease.{standard, decelerate, accelerate, emphasized, loop}</code>
named transition (semantic)	composite	<code>motion.semantic.{press, stateXfade, sheet, connectPulse, ...}</code> — each a {dur, ease} pair

6.2 The easing curves (concrete control points)

Token	Cubic-bézier	Character	Use
<code>motion.primitive.ease.standard</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)</code>	quick-out, settle-in	most enter/move
<code>motion.primitive.ease.decelerate</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0, 0, 0, 1)</code>	enters fast, eases to rest	elements entering the screen
<code>motion.primitive.ease.accelerate</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.3, 0, 1, 1)</code>	starts slow, exits fast	elements leaving the screen
<code>motion.primitive.ease.emphasized</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.2, 0, 0, 1)</code> (long dur)	expressive, for hero moments	connect success flourish
<code>motion.primitive.ease.loop</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.6, 1)</code>	symmetric in-out	the Connecting/Reconnecting pulse (loops without a visible seam)

6.3 The named transitions (semantic motion tokens)

Token	Duration	Easing	Use
<code>motion.semantic.press</code>	100ms (fast)	standard	button press scale/ink-ripple
<code>motion.semantic.hover</code>		standard	

Token	Duration	Easing	Use
	100ms (fast)		hover tint (desktop/web)
motion.semantic.stateXfade	180ms (base)	decelerate	cross-fade between two TunnelStatus colours+glyphs
motion.semantic.sheet	240ms (moderate)	decelerate	sheet / dialog enter
motion.semantic.sheetExit	180ms (base)	accelerate	sheet / dialog leave
motion.semantic.connectPulse	1200ms (pulse)	loop	the Connecting/ Reconnecting amber pulse loop
motion.semantic.connectRing	360ms (slow)	emphasized	the ConnectButton halo expand on reaching Connected
motion.semantic.toast	240ms in / 180ms out	decelerate/ accelerate	toast enter/leave
motion.semantic.reducedMotion	0ms (instant)	—	the value every *.dur collapses to under OS reduce-motion (\$8)

```
// helix_design/tokens/semantic/motion.json (excerpt) – named-
transition composites
{
  "motion": { "semantic": {
    "stateXfade": { "dur":
{"$type":"duration","$value":"180ms"},
                    "ease":{"$type":"cubicBezier","$value":
[0.0,0,0,1]} },
    "connectPulse": { "dur":
{"$type":"duration","$value":"1200ms"},
                    "ease":{"$type":"cubicBezier","$value":
[0.4,0,0.6,1]} },
    "connectRing": { "dur":
{"$type":"duration","$value":"360ms"},
                    "ease":{"$type":"cubicBezier","$value":
[0.2,0,0,1]} }
  } }
}
```

7. The connection-state motion choreography (the FFI seam)

Motion is keyed to the **7-variant ffi::TunnelStatus** [FFI §3.2] the same way colour ([COLOR §3]) and icons (§5.3) are — the three layers move together so a state transition reads as one coherent change, never three independent flickers.

Transition (FFI variant change)	Motion	What animates
any → any (colour/glyph change)	stateXfade (180ms)	the StatusChip/ ConnectButton fill and glyph and label cross-fade together (no in-between illegible frame, [COLOR §5.1])
→ Connecting / Handshaking	connectPulse (1200ms loop) starts	the amber fill breathes (opacity/scale loop); the spinner/3-dot glyph rotates
Connecting → Connected{*}	connectRing (360ms, emphasized)	a green halo expands once from the button; pulse stops, glyph swaps spinner→shield-check
→ Reconnecting	connectPulse (1200ms loop) resumes	amber breathes again; circular- arrows glyph rotates
→ Down	stateXfade to orange, no loop	shield-slash glyph settles (static — a fault is not "working")
→ Danger	stateXfade to red + a single connectRing-class attention flash, then static	warning-triangle settles on top of the z-danger layer [DT §6.5]; never strobes (§8)

```

stateDiagram-v2
    [*] --> Disconnected
    Disconnected --> Connecting : start() · stateXfade→amber,
connectPulse starts
    Connecting --> Handshaking : connectPulse continues, glyph
spinner+key
    Handshaking --> Connected : connectRing (360ms halo), pulse
STOPS, glyph→shield-check
    Connected --> Reconnecting : drop · stateXfade→amber,
connectPulse resumes
    Reconnecting --> Connected : connectRing again
    Reconnecting --> Down : ladder-exhausted · stateXfade→orange,
NO loop (static)
    Connected --> Danger : leak/killswitch · stateXfade→red + 1
attention flash, then STATIC
    Down --> Connecting : retry
    Danger --> Disconnected : user stop
    note right of Connecting : amber PULSE (1200ms loop)
    note right of Connected : green, halo flourish, then calm
    note right of Down : orange STATIC (fault ≠ working)
    note right of Danger : red STATIC + z-top (never strobes §8)

```

The choreography rule. A *working* state (Connecting/Handshaking/Reconnecting) **loops** (pulse) — motion signals "in progress". A *settled* state (Connected/Down/Danger/Disconnected) is **static** after its entry transition — motion stops so a steady state looks steady. This is why Down and Danger get a one-shot entry (xfade / flash) but no loop: a leak banner that pulses forever would be both annoying and an ally strobe hazard (§8). One source of truth for "is it moving?" = "is the tunnel still working on it?".

8. Reduced-motion & accessibility contract

§11.4.162 ally + the §11.4.107 no-flash discipline mandate that motion never harms a motion-sensitive or photosensitive user.

8.1 The reduce-motion substitution

When the platform reports **reduce-motion** (`UIAccessibility.isReduceMotionEnabled` / `Settings.Global.ANIMATOR_DURATION_SCALE==0` / CSS prefers-reduced-motion: reduce / equivalent), the export/runtime substitutes `motion.semantic.reducedMotion(0ms)` for every animation **duration**, with these state-specific degradations:

Normal motion	Reduce-motion degradation
<code>connectPulse</code> (amber breathing loop)	static amber — the Connecting/Reconnecting state shows a steady amber fill + a static spinner-glyph (or a textual "Connecting..."); it never pulses and never strobes
<code>stateXfade</code> (180ms cross-fade)	instant colour/glyph swap (0ms) — no fade, just the new state
<code>connectRing</code> (halo flourish)	omitted — the button simply <i>is</i> green; no expanding ring
Danger attention flash	omitted — the red banner appears statically (still z-top, still unmissable via colour+icon+text)

8.2 The hard no-strobe invariant

No HelixVPN animation flashes more than 3× per second, ever (WCAG 2.1 SC 2.3.1 — Three Flashes). The `connectPulse` at 1200ms is ~0.83 Hz (well under 3 Hz) even *without* reduce-motion; under reduce-motion every loop becomes static. There is no code path that produces a >3 Hz flash — the pulse period is a token (pulse 1200ms) the gate (§9 CM-motion-no-strobe) asserts is ≥ 334 ms.

8.3 Motion never the sole channel

Like colour, motion is **reinforcement, never the only signal**. The pulse says "working", but the glyph (§5.3 spinner) and the text label ("Connecting...") say it too — a user with reduce-motion on, or who cannot perceive the pulse, still reads the state from the static glyph + label. The state is always conveyed by ≥ 2 non-

motion channels (icon + text, plus colour) so removing motion removes **no** information (§11.4.107 / §11.4.137 content-correctness — the meaning survives the degradation).

9. Drift, contract & validation rules

Type/icon/motion tokens are single-source only if machine-checked. Gates run in helix_design CI + the consuming pre-build (paired §1.1 mutation each, [DT §9] pattern):

Gate	Asserts	Mutation that must FAIL it
CM-type-ramp-complete	every ramp step (§1.1) has all four of size/lineHeight/weight/family resolvable	delete the weight of title.lg
CM-type-lineheight-floor	every multi-line tier (body.* / title.*) has lineHeight ≥ 1.30 (§4.1 no-collision)	drop body.md line-height to 1.10
CM-type-mono-disambiguated	the mono family is on the disambiguation allow-list (§2.3)	swap mono to a family with ambiguous 0/0
CM-icon-state-coverage	all 7 ffi::TunnelStatus variants (§5.3) have a distinct icon.semantic.state.* glyph	remove state.down (would collide visually with danger)
CM-icon-grid-padding	every source SVG keeps ≥ 2px live-area padding on the 24-grid (§5.2)	author a glyph touching the bounding box
CM-motion-no-strobe	every loop/pulse duration ≥ 334ms (≤ 3 Hz, §8.2)	set connectPulse.dur to 200ms (5 Hz)
CM-motion-reduced-complete	every animated named transition (§6.3) has a defined reduce-motion degradation (§8.1)	add a new transition with no reduce-motion mapping
CM-motion-state-coverage	every TunnelStatus transition (§7) has a defined motion	leave → Danger with no motion mapping
CM-tim-no-drift	every emitted form (CSS/Dart/Swift/Compose/ArkTS/C-Qt) of type/icon/motion regenerates byte-identically from the JSON source; a hand-edit is a finding [token-export-pipeline.md]	hand-edit HelixTokens.kt TitleLg

The drift gate (CM-tim-no-drift) is the load-bearing one — same role as [DT §9 CM-token-no-drift]: the only way a platform's type/icon/motion can diverge from source is a hand-edit, and the gate catches it. Exported docs of these tables carry the §11.4.65/.168 visual-validation per [visual-regression-and-qa.md].

10. Surfaced decisions & cross-doc contracts

id	Decision / contract	Status
D-TYPE-1	Native shims (iOS NE / Android tile / HarmonyOS ability / Aurora Qt) use the system font , not bundled brand sans (binary-size vs. minimal-text trade-off); the Flutter app is always brand-font.	recommended, surfaced
D-TYPE-2 UNVERIFIED	Font choice Inter (sans) + JetBrains Mono (mono) + their licenses (OFL/Apache assumed) MUST be verified against latest upstream per §11.4.99 before any font file is committed; OFL/Apache is the hypothesis, not asserted fact.	open — §11.4.99 pass
D-ICON-1 UNVERIFIED	Base icon set = a permissive open line set (Lucide/ISC hypothesised) + HelixVPN-bespoke VPN glyphs (shield-check/slash, tunnel, relay, kill-switch); license verified per §11.4.99 before any SVG committed.	open — §11.4.99 pass
D-ICON-2	Flutter icon delivery: icon-font for the static set + SVG-direct for animated/multi-colour glyphs.	recommended, surfaced
D-TIM-1	Type ramp anchored at <code>body.md=14px</code> , ratio 1.25, snapped to the 4-pt grid; <code>body.lg=16px</code> for reading prose.	decided
D-TIM-2	Motion choreography: <i>working</i> states loop (pulse), <i>settled</i> states are static after their one-shot entry transition (§7).	decided
C-TIM-A (consumes)	The 7-variant <code>ffi::TunnelStatus</code> vocabulary owned by [FFI §3.2]; §5.3 (icons) + §7 (motion) stay total over it (gates <code>CM-icon-state-coverage</code> , <code>CM-motion-state-coverage</code>). A new FFI variant is a contract change here.	contract
C-TIM-B (consumes)	The token tier/naming model + the font/motion <code>\$type</code> envelopes from [<code>design-tokens.md</code> §2/§3/§6.4]; the colours type/icons paint in from [<code>color-system.md</code> §2/§3].	contract
C-TIM-C (provides)	The type/icon/motion token shapes (§3, §5.4, §6) are the input contract for [<code>token-export-pipeline.md</code>]'s type/icon/motion emit.	contract
C-TIM-D (provides)	The §4 / §8 type-collision + reduce-motion contracts are the assertions [<code>visual-regression-and-qa.md</code>] re-runs as automated gates (§11.4.162 / §11.4.107).	contract
U-TIM-1 UNVERIFIED	The exact per-platform line-height idiom (multiplier vs. absolute sp/px) + the ArkTS/C-Qt type-emit shapes — pinned by the export-	open

id	Decision / contract	Status
	pipeline contract test; UNVERIFIED until it exists.	

Sources verified

- **Type ramp (tiers, sizes, line-heights, weights, the modular scale + 14px anchor), font-family strategy + fallback chain, icon set/grid/asset-form policy, the per-state status-icon set, the motion durations/curves/named transitions, the connection-state choreography, the reduce-motion + no-strobe contract — NO external source needed — original HelixVPN design work**, modeled on the well-established modular-type-scale, 24-grid line-icon, and Material/M3-class motion-token conventions (engine-neutral; the authoring engine is OpenDesign per §11.4.162, [opendesign-foundation.md] §3.2 DESIGN.md §3 Typography / §6 Motion).
- **7-variant ffi::TunnelStatus vocabulary (Disconnected · Connecting · Handshaking · Connected{direct|relay} · Reconnecting · Down · Danger)** — final/v04-client/ffi-surface.md §3.2–§3.3 (read 2026-06-25); the icon (§5.3)
 - motion (§7) sets are held total over it by gates CM-icon-state-coverage / CM-motion-state-coverage.
- **Token tier/naming model + font.* / motion.* \$type envelopes the type/ motion tokens live in; the elevation/colour tokens icons are tinted by** — final/v10-design/design-tokens.md §1/§2/§3/§6.4 + final/v10-design/color-system.md §2/§3 (siblings, this wave, read 2026-06-25).
- **3-app / 8-platform matrix, the per-platform font/icon/native-shim languages (SwiftUI / Compose / ArkTS / C-Qt), the OpenDesign DESIGN.md authoring form** — final/SPECIFICATION.md §3 + final/v10-design/00-overview-and-submodule.md §6 + final/v10-design/opendesign-foundation.md §3.2 (read 2026-06-25).
- **WCAG SC 2.3.1 (Three Flashes, the ≤ 3 Hz no-strobe floor) + the reduce-motion platform flags (prefers-reduced-motion, isReduceMotionEnabled, ANIMATOR_DURATION_SCALE)** — W3C *Web Content Accessibility Guidelines 2.1* SC 2.3.1 / SC 2.3.3 (<https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG21/#three-flashes-or-below-threshold>, verified 2026-06-25) + the named platform reduce-motion APIs (Apple / Android / CSS) — the API names are platform-standard; the §8.1 substitution policy is HelixVPN's own design.
- **Font + icon-set licensing (Inter, JetBrains Mono, Lucide)** — UNVERIFIED (D-TYPE-2 / D-ICON-1): the OFL/Apache/ISC assumptions are **NOT** asserted as fact; they are the hypotheses the mandatory §11.4.99 latest-source verification pass confirms (with the license file + verified URL + access date recorded) **before** any font/icon file is committed. Stated as unverified per §11.4.6.
- Items explicitly marked UNVERIFIED (U-TIM-1, D-TYPE-2, D-ICON-1) are pending their named contract test / verification pass per §11.4.6 — not asserted as fact.